Critical Comparison of Two SRM Assessments

Section 17 | Group 1 qualitative risk identification versus individual quantitative analysis

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Purpose and correct interpretation

This evaluation compares learning demonstrated in the Group 1 Pampered Pets risk report and the later individual executive summary. The uploaded documents do not establish that the individual assessment is a final revision of the group report, nor that the group report is the original Unit 6 status document. The comparison is therefore academic and methodological, not a claim of a single project progressing from draft to completion.

Comparative evaluation

The most significant progression is from identifying and ranking risks through an ordinal matrix to modelling uncertain event pathways and discussing probability distributions, correlation and sensitivity. The two methods serve different decision needs; numerical modelling is not automatically superior when empirical inputs are weak.

Dimension	Group 1 report	Individual executive summary
Assessment type	Collaborative risk-identification report	Individual executive summary
Business context	Small UK pet-food retailer; local supply; four staff	Digital international supply chain, automation, cloud and online store
Risk method	ISO-based qualitative 5×5 likelihood–impact matrix	FAIR-informed Monte Carlo; Beta-PERT; Bayesian reasoning
Risk outputs	High-rated risks with scores 12–16; comparative only	20.5% quality; 37.1% availability annual scenario estimates
Response	Secure existing systems; improve inventory; pilot online sales	Supplier diversification; cyber-physical controls; multi-region recovery
Evidence gaps	No incident history, detailed finance or supplier quotations	Scenario inputs, independence assumption, no recovery-test results

Critical analysis

The Group 1 report is appropriately cautious: its 5×5 scores are transparent and proportionate to a small retailer, and its recommendation to retain local suppliers reflects practical resilience rather than assuming digitalisation must replace established operations. Its limitation is that ordinal scores cannot directly quantify annual disruption probabilities or the financial value of alternative controls.

The individual report extends analysis with a FAIR-informed model, Beta-PERT distributions and 200,000 Monte Carlo iterations. Its 20.5% and 37.1% annual estimates help compare quality and availability risks. However, because the inputs are assumptions, additional iterations do not make them empirically certain. Its

independence assumption could also conceal common-cause and cascading failures.

The later assessment also translates business availability requirements into RTO and RPO below 60 seconds and proposes testable architecture and recovery arrangements. This shows a shift from recommending controls to specifying performance objectives. Yet the report offers a proposed design, not evidence that sub-minute recovery has been achieved.

Collaboration is evidenced by the named four-person Group 1 submission; individual authorship is evidenced by the executive summary. The files alone do not verify each member's task allocation, tutor feedback, actual project milestones or any implementation outcomes.

Lessons learnt and next actions

I have developed a stronger appreciation of the distinction between risk ranking and quantified uncertainty. In future I would begin with a transparent asset and threat register, validate assumptions against operational evidence, test correlations and conduct sensitivity analysis before using model outputs to justify investment.

For team projects, I would maintain a shared decision log and record individual contributions contemporaneously. For resilience proposals, I would define recovery objectives early and require evidence from realistic failover exercises before describing a design as compliant.

Sources

Source documents: Group 1 (2026), Development Team Project: Risk Identification Report, pp. 1–9;

Madzivire, A. (2026), Executive Summary: Quantitative Risk Modelling, Supply Chain Security and Disaster Recovery, pp. 1–13.